

BRANDON MINER

San Francisco, CA

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Data Scientist — Statistical modeling, NLP pipelines, and end-to-end ML products in civic and public-interest contexts

Education

University of San Francisco

M.S. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

San Francisco, CA

Expected Jun 2026

- *Distributed Computing*
- *Machine Learning*
- *Deep Learning*
- *Experiments* / Experiments in Data Science

San Diego State University

B.S. in Statistics with Emphasis in Data Science, Minor in Mathematics

San Diego, CA

Dec 2025

Experience

Data Scientist

ACLU

San Francisco, CA

Oct 2025 – Present

- Architecting the product development of an end-to-end ML video auditing platform from scratch (**Python, FastAPI, MySQL, Docker**) to automate data processing and analysis of unstructured police bodycam footage, projected to eliminate **300+ hours** of manual review per monthly cycle.
- Developing a GPU-accelerated **ETL pipeline** using **FFmpeg** and **Whisper**-based speech-to-text to ingest, transcribe, and process batches of **600+ videos per month**; integrated **LLM-driven auto-labeling** to generate fine-tuning data for multi-stage text classification models extracting actionable audit signals.
- Designed and trained **multi-stage NLP classifiers** on auto-labeled transcripts to detect use-of-force indicators, rights violations, and officer conduct patterns at scale.
- Built a **private-server FastAPI backend** and **React.js** web frontend to deliver the full auditing system to non-technical stakeholders, enabling self-service model inference without engineering overhead.

Data Scientist, Lead Intern

San Diego County Taxpayers Association

San Diego, CA

Mar 2024 – Aug 2025

- Led data science initiatives, managing a team of **4+ associates** to deliver statistical insights on civil workforce economics and regional homelessness programs using statistical data analysis.
- Built a public workforce analytics pipeline combining **iterative web scraping** and **NLP-based entity standardization** to clean and link heterogeneous salary records; applied regression modeling to quantify a **19.7% police wage increase per 1% staffing drop**.
- Applied **mixed-effects regression models** with multicollinearity reduction (VIF analysis) to regional homelessness expenditure data, surfacing high-impact interventions such as rapid rehousing to guide resource allocation decisions.

Technical Projects

California Grape ETL Pipeline & Dashboard

- Engineered a **multi-source ETL pipeline** in Python to extract, transform, and consolidate disparate agricultural datasets into a unified schema optimized for downstream analysis.
- **Developed an interactive Streamlit front-end** dashboard for real-time filtering and visualization of regional production metrics.
- Developed an **interactive Streamlit dashboard** enabling end-users to dynamically visualize and filter regional production metrics; view live deployment.

Credit Card Fraud Detection

- Built a binary classification model using **Logistic Regression (Scikit-Learn)** to identify fraudulent transactions on a highly imbalanced dataset.
- Tuned classification threshold via **ROC-AUC analysis** to minimize False Negative Rate (missed fraud) while capping False Positive Rate at **under 2%**.

Technical Skills

Programming & Statistical Tools: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, PyTorch, Streamlit), R (tidyverse), SQL (PostgreSQL), Bash

Modeling & Analysis: regression, mixed-effects models, NLP pipelines, classification, PCA, multicollinearity reduction (VIF), ROC-AUC threshold optimization, imbalanced classification, experimental design

Data Engineering: multi-source ETL pipelines, web scraping, text normalization, entity standardization

Communication & Delivery: Streamlit dashboards, stakeholder-facing analytics, team leadership